

**TEXT OF REMARKS BY PROF. AHMED TIJJANI MORA, PhD, FPSN, FPCPharm,
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Chairman, Governing Council of the Pharmacists Council of Nigeria (PCN)

**Presented on the Occasion of the Opening Ceremony of a Sensitisation
Workshop to Kick-Start the Implementation of the Pharmacist Consultant
Cadre within the Healthcare System in Nigeria**

Tuesday, 18th May 2021, Banquet Hall, NAF Conference Centre & Suite, Abuja

Protocol

We are privileged to have in our midst for this Opening Ceremony:

- The Honourable Minister of Health, **Dr. Osagie Ehanire**;
- The Head of the Civil Service of the Federation, **Dr. Folasade Yemi-Esan**;
- Leadership of the Committees on Health and Establishment from the Senate and the House of Representatives.

Your presence today underscores the significance of this healthcare and establishment event, hosted by the **Pharmacists Council of Nigeria (PCN)**.

The **LFN Act No. 17 of 2004**, which establishes the PCN with the mandate of regulating and controlling pharmacy education, training, and practice, is instrumental to this historic gathering of leaders from both the Executive and Legislative arms of government under one roof.

Historical Context

In September 2006, the PCN received the *“Report of the Pharmacists Council of Nigeria (PCN) Visitation Panel to the West African Postgraduate College of Pharmacists (WAPCP).”*

Exactly fourteen (14) years later, on **11th September 2020**, the Head of the Civil Service of the Federation released a circular titled: *“Approved Scheme of Service for Pharmacist Consultant Cadre in the Federal Civil/Public Service.”*

Between 2006 and 2020, pharmacists in Nigeria and four other Anglophone West African countries underwent active training for the Fellowship programme of the WAPCP, which was established **45 years ago in Monrovia, Liberia**, initially as the **West African Pharmaceutical Federation (WAPF)**.

The National Council on Establishment (NCE), the PCN, the WAPCP, and other stakeholders actively engaged to ensure recognition of the College's Fellows within the Pharmacist Consultant cadre in the Federal Civil/Public Service.

Notably, the now-defunct **Pharmacists Board of Nigeria (PBN)** initiated the route to the Pharmacist Consultant cadre through visits by Nigerian Deans of Pharmacy to selected Schools of Pharmacy in the **UK and USA** in 1992. This initiative aimed to study Clinical Pharmacy curricula in advanced countries and was sponsored by the Federal Ministry of Health.

The focus areas were:

- Prescribing decisions;
- Monitoring and modifying drug therapy;
- Counselling patients on the ward prior to discharge; and
- Benefits to patients in the community.

Following this initiative, the **National Universities Commission (NUC)** directed the creation of **Departments of Clinical Pharmacy and Pharmacy Practice/Management** in all Nigerian Faculties of Pharmacy. The WAPCP Fellowship programme aligns directly with Clinical Pharmacy topics at the undergraduate Bachelor of Pharmacy level in Nigerian universities.

Faculties of WAPCP

1. Faculty of Drugs Production and Quality Assurance
2. Faculty of Social and Administrative Pharmacy
3. Faculty of Clinical Pharmacy
4. Faculty of Community Pharmacy
5. Faculty of Public Health Pharmacy

Purpose of the Workshop

In recognition of the Pharmacist Consultant cadre by the Federal Government, the PCN—mandated by law to regulate pharmacy education, training, and practice—is organizing this workshop to **kick-start a series of workshops** in Lagos, Enugu, and Kaduna. These workshops will induct the newly approved Pharmacist Consultants as they embark on this new phase of professional practice in:

- Federal, State, and Local Government health services; and
- Organised private sector healthcare facilities, for the benefit of patients and the overall healthcare system.

Keynote Address

At this workshop, the **Keynote Address** will be delivered by **Professor N. N. Wannang, FPCPharm**, of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, University of Jos, and Immediate Past Secretary General of the WAPCP.

The Pharmacist Consultant must be properly inducted into this officially designated role, emphasizing collaboration with other healthcare professionals to provide **advanced and integrated healthcare services**, with specific focus on **pharmaceutical care** in healthcare facilities across the country.

Collaboration with Other Healthcare Professions

Representatives from the **Pharmaceutical Society of Nigeria (PSN)**, **Nigerian Medical Association (NMA)**, **Nigerian Association of Nurses and Midwives (NANM)**, **Medical Laboratory Scientists Council of Nigeria (MLSCN)**, and other healthcare professions have been invited.

Pharmacist Consultants are expected to work **side by side with Medical Doctors, Nurses, Medical Laboratory Scientists**, and others in public healthcare facilities, ensuring holistic patient care.

Message to Fellows

To my colleagues—Fellows of the College and now Pharmacist Consultants—this is a **defining moment** for the pharmacy profession. This workshop comes at a critical time, as Nigeria and the world continue to battle the COVID-19 pandemic, which has persisted for the past fifteen (15) months.

We anticipate a **highly educative, informative, and professionally enriching workshop**.

Thank you.

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